BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

US Life Science Tools & Diagnostics

Agilent Technologies Inc

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

A **180.00 USD**



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Agilent: Applied Markets Group (AMG) site visit takeaways

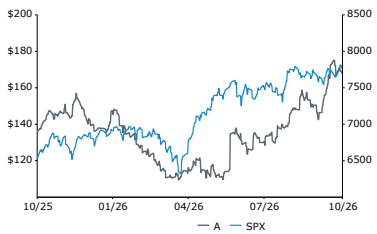
Agilent welcomed a Bernstein-organized investor group to its Little Falls site in Wilmington, DE on Thursday for a management discussion focused on the Applied Markets Group (slides) and a lab tour. The visit highlighted customer-led innovation, opportunities across applied markets, and operational improvements supporting the business. Below are our quick key takeaways.

Close Date	8 Oct 2026
A Close Price (USD)	168.17
Price Target (USD)	180.00
Upside/(Downside)	7%
52-Week Range	177.05/108.35
SPX	7,765.36
FYE	Oct
Div Yield	0.6%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	47,412
EV (USD) (M)	49,802

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	23.6	16.2	45.7	20.0
SPX (%)	13.4	1.2	14.5	15.0
Relative (%)	10.2	15.0	31.3	5.0

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Business operations

Innovation is strong and a key focus of the company, both in analytical capabilities and in addressing customer needs for higher lab productivity. Close customer engagement helps guide development toward the things customers really value - for example, higher throughput, lower operating costs, and easier-to-use systems. Recent launches illustrate this approach: e.g., the new GCs offer 30% faster cooldown (Exhibit 1), while the 9500 ICP-MS delivers >30% faster acquisition and up to 20x improved sensitivity (Exhibit 2). *(We saw these instruments live on the lab tour - reach out if you'd like to hear more.)*

Agilent is investing meaningfully in strengthening their operations, with evidence that the changes are working. Since Joydeep Ganguly joined in October 2025 as an SVP, Agilent Global Operations, and Chief Operations and Quality Officer, there have been many changes to operations (e.g., investments in talent, global planning, and digital engineering, alongside a more flexible regional manufacturing network). Proof points have been positive: for example, Agilent was able to meet the 3Q demand spike despite a leaner operations team, and performance against customer-requested delivery dates (CRDD) has exceeded 95% for six consecutive months. Ganguly framed the goal as building lasting capability in the organization (not exclusively cutting cost), telling division heads: "don't let ops be the rate-limiting factor for driving innovation and meeting demand anymore."

Products and end markets

Gas chromatography (GC) is not used exclusively in industrial / applied end markets - it also has meaningful pharma exposure. Approximately 20% of Agilent's GC business serves pharma, with applications including raw-material screening across small-molecule and biologics manufacturing, and residual-solvent analysis in small-molecule production. Pharma reshoring is therefore also a GC story, broadening the opportunity beyond the LC instruments investors typically associate with these investments.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
A (USD)	5.59	6.21	6.92

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	6,948	7,508	8,011	7.4%

Valuation Metrics	25A	26E	27E
EV/Adj EBITDA (x)	25.3	23.7	21.5
Adjusted P/E (x)	30.1	27.1	24.3

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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Autonomous labs are an emerging opportunity across instruments, services, and consumables, with early commercial traction already visible. Management highlighted the need for more modular, robot-accessible instruments that fit into autonomous-lab racks, although near-term adoption will likely involve retrofitting existing fleets. Agilent already has GC-based implementations in China and recently secured a $5M order from an AI company pursuing drug discovery, accompanied by a three-year service contract. Over time, predictive maintenance could expand the service offering, while moving from eight-hour to round-the-clock operation could support higher consumables usage.

Airport security is also a real opportunity. Agilent's Insight platform offers several benefits vs. status quo (e.g., faster alarm resolution and fewer false alarms, while handling liquids, gels, solids, and powders on a single system - Exhibit 3). It has already been deployed at some US airports serving World Cup host cities, with progress also underway in Europe. Management highlighted a recent second TSA contract win, underscoring the early commercial traction. Broader adoption remains to be seen, but it isn't difficult to dimensionalize a meaningful new growth opportunity (e.g., TAM could potentially encompass every security line in each of the global airports...)

Cell analysis is showing green shoots, although the impact is not yet material at the company level. Management said the business inflected in 3Q, and they expect to see more growth fueled by demand for AI-related data generation. However, cell analysis accounts for only 3–4% of Agilent revenue, meaning that improvement in this segment has not (yet) translated into a material contribution to full-company growth.

Agilent's particular China strength reflects where and how it competes, rather than a fully broad-based market recovery. Management highlighted strength across its core exposures, with pharma growing >20% in 3Q, chemicals and advanced materials up high teens, and food also contributing. Semiconductor demand was similarly strong, growing high teens in China, although the opportunity extends across Asia-Pacific. At the same time, Agilent is under-indexed to the (still) weaker A&G and diagnostics markets. Management also emphasized that its long-standing local presence helps Agilent engage with fast-moving private companies in China, where the pace of innovation is particularly high.

Our take: *We came away with greater confidence in Agilent's ability to turn innovation into growth, supported by closer customer engagement and more responsive operations. The opportunity is broader than a traditional instrument replacement story, with new applications and evolving lab workflows creating potential for both instrument sales and recurring revenue.*

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EXHIBIT 1: **Agilent's new GCs improve throughput while reducing resource use and downtime**



Source: Company presentation

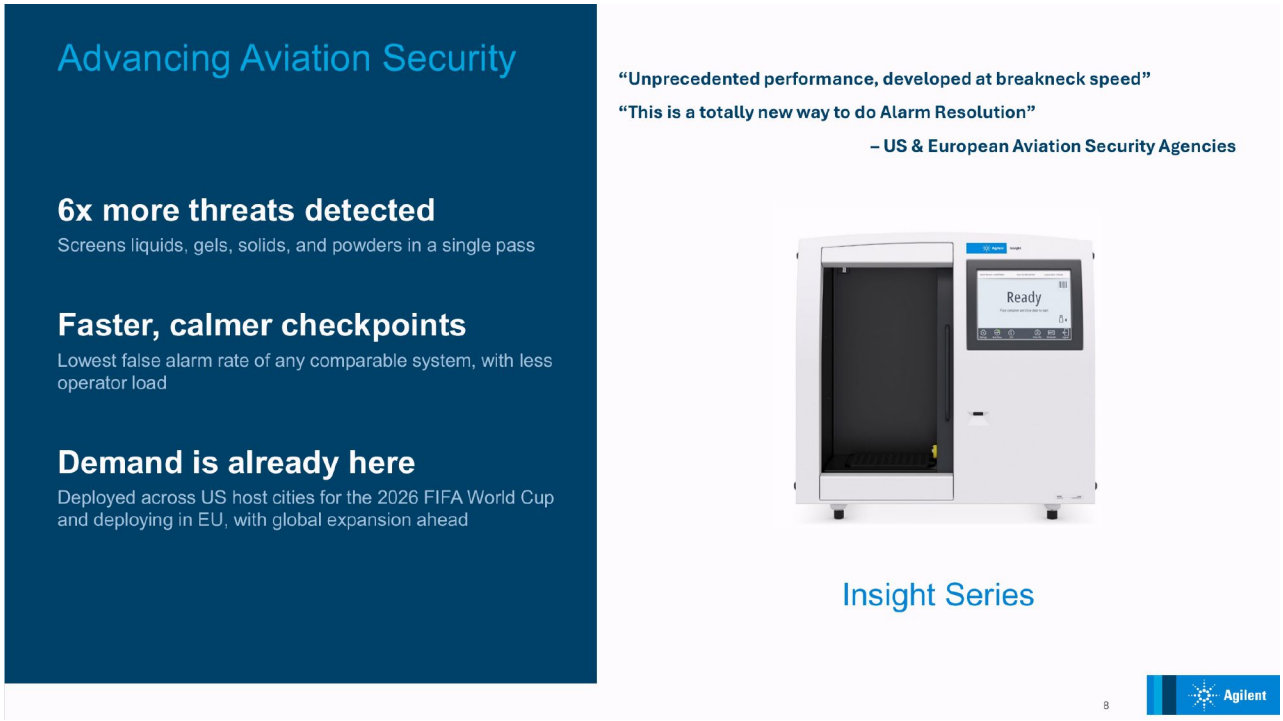
EXHIBIT 2: **The 9500 ICP-MS combines faster acquisition with improved sensitivity**



Source: Company presentation

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EXHIBIT 3: **Agilent's Insight platform offers faster alarm resolution with fewer false alarms**



Source: Company presentation

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INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We maintain our Outperform rating on Agilent.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			8 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
A (Agilent)	O	USD	168.17	180.00	5.0%	USD	5.59	6.21	6.92	30.1	27.1	24.3
SPX			7,765.36									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Agilent Technologies Inc

We arrive at our price target of $180 by taking the average of a DCF, PE multiple, and EV/EBITDA multiple approach (rounded to nearest $5 increment). Our DCF valuation of $177 uses a WACC of 9% and a terminal growth rate of 4.5%. Our PE multiple valuation of $180 uses a 26x 2027E earnings multiple. Our EV/EBITDA valuation of $180 uses a 22x 2027E EBITDA multiple.

RISKS

Agilent Technologies Inc

Downside Risks

- Instrument up-cycle is not as meaningful as investors expect
- Unable to cash in on growth strategies
- China weakness

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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on events and developments.

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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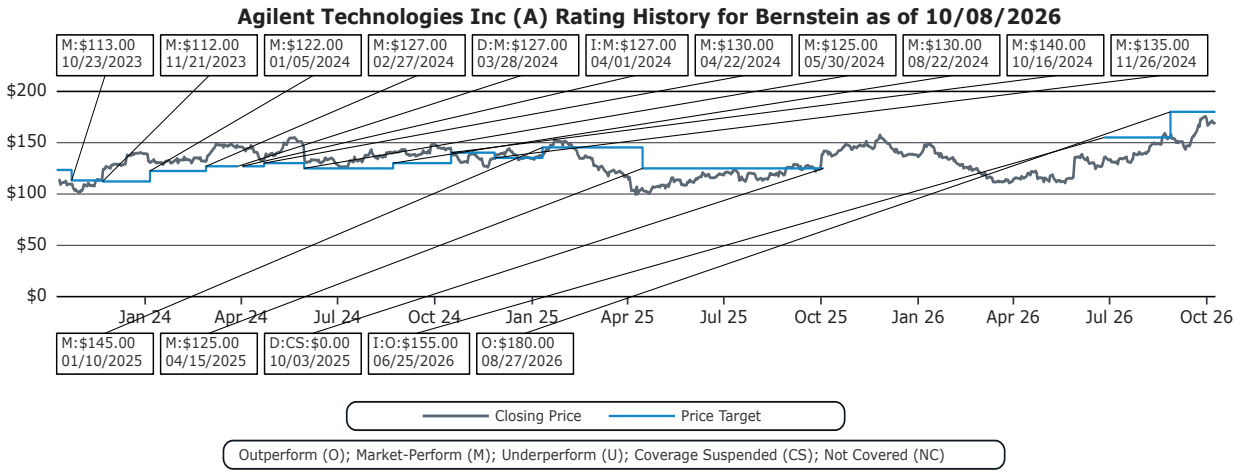
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Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
As of September 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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